Livestock

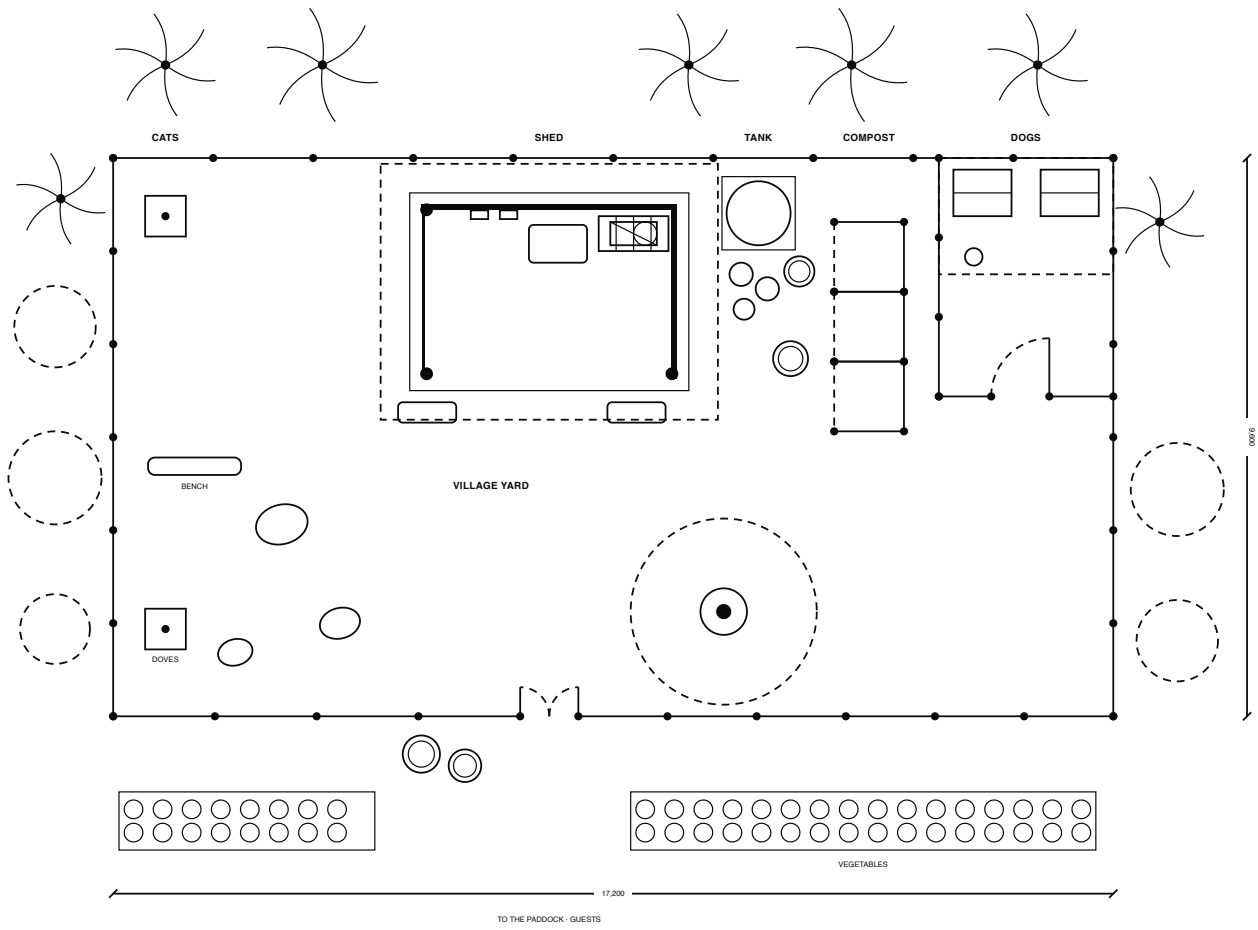
# Execution plan

How to start the farm's first animals: 6 goats and 4 sheep in one village yard with the farm friends the guests meet, the checks before any animal arrives, the daily care and the rules.

Status: plan of 2026-10-31. No animal arrives before the checks below; the yard's site waits for the 200 m lake measurement. The yard's sizes are design intent in livestock.json until the farm's vet or an animal-housing adviser checks them [A].

Kinyarwanda: soma iyi gahunda mu Kinyarwanda · Print: this plan as a PDF · The yard drawn: the livestock page · Its other pages: materials, water

## At a glance




| What | Design |
| --- | --- |
| The herd | 10 animals: 6 local goats and 4 fat-tailed hair sheep (D-030) |

| What | Design |
|---|---|
| The shed | one thatched shed copied from the founder's photo, 4.4 × 3.0 m on a fieldstone-edged plinth, open at the front; the goats and the sheep sleep together (D-044) |
| The yard | one village yard inside one post-and-rail fence of eucalyptus poles 1.2 m high, straw over the earth, fieldstones to climb, a shade tree (D-039, D-047) |
| Farm friends | free-flying doves in a dovecote and 3 neutered cats, for the guests to meet and not for sale; two guard dogs in a run of their own (D-038, D-040) |
| Water | a 1,000 L tank on a fieldstone base feeding two float troughs by gravity (water) |
| The loop | the litter and the manure to three compost bays, then to the vegetable beds (farming) |

### What to keep, and why

| Animal | Decision | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Goats | 6 local does to start (D-030) | wait until the district vet confirms the Rift Valley fever and movement status in writing [V LVS-03, LVS-29] |
| Sheep | 4 fat-tailed hair sheep (D-030) | kept with the goats, their minerals apart: copper in goat minerals is toxic to sheep [V LVS-26] |
| Broilers | Only for the kitchen, if at all | Farm-gate prices in 2025 were below the cost of raising them [V LVS-72] |
| Pigs | Not now | African swine fever: pig trade and movement banned in Bugesera since 2026-04-10, not lifted [V REG-22] |
| Rabbits | Not kept (D-040) | No vaccination programme found; not insured [V MKT-21] |

## Before you start

1. **Register as a keeper** under the new animal law, in force since its publication on 2026-09-11: keepers register, only a vet treats animals, and every move needs a movement certificate [V REG-24].
2. **Measure the distances:** the shed at least 200 m from the lake's furthest flood line and 20 m from any swamp; a breach costs RWF 500,000 and demolition [V LOC-01, LOC-02].
3. **Name a vet:** the sector or district veterinary officer, or a private vet from the mandated companies [V LOC-48].
4. **Buy through the vet:** each animal comes with its movement certificate and waits in a quarantine pen at least 30 m away before it joins the herd (D-030).

## Steps

1. **Fence and water first:** the yard's post-and-rail fence and its gate, the tank on its base and the two troughs (water).
2. **The shed:** the plinth, then the frame of barked eucalyptus posts and beams, the upright boards at the back and the east end, the steep grass thatch, then the straw (materials).
3. **The yard:** straw over the earth, the fieldstones, a pole guard round the shade tree, the mineral boxes (the goats' high, the sheep's low).
4. **The compost bays:** three pole bays east of the feed store, for the litter and the manure.
5. **The friends and the dogs:** the dovecote on its pole, the cats' house on its post, and the dogs' run with its two kennels.
6. **The animals:** the goats and the sheep from their quarantine, once the checks are done.

### Every day, every week

| When | The goats and the sheep |
|---|---|
| Morning | let out to the yard, water, look at the eyes, coat and droppings |
| Evening | bring in, hay, water, close the shed |
| Every week | clear the straw to the compost, check the hooves |
| As the vet says | PPR vaccination; deworming, since worms kill most goats [V LVS-14, LVS-10] |

## Selling

1. Goats and sheep are sold live: selling meat needs a RICA slaughter licence, a registered premise and a registered carrier [V REG-03, REG-06].
2. Meat served in the galley comes from a licensed slaughterhouse.
3. The national agricultural insurance scheme covers poultry, not goats [V MKT-21]: the herd is not insured.

## Hold points

1. **No animal before the checks.** The keeper registered, the distances measured, a vet named, the Rift Valley fever status confirmed in writing.
2. **Quarantine first.** Every new animal waits 30 m away before it joins the herd.
3. **Minerals apart.** The goats' minerals hang high, where the sheep cannot reach them [V LVS-26].

4. **Compost hot.** The compost reaches 55 °C for 3 days, turned, before it touches anything eaten.

## Done when

1. The keeper is registered, the 200 m and 20 m distances are measured, and a vet is named.
2. The fence, the water, the shed and the yard are built, and the troughs fill.
3. The 10 animals are in, and every head, treatment and kilogram of feed is recorded.

## Open questions

1. How far are the field and the yard from the lake's flood line?
2. Who keeps the animals every day, and who covers their day off?
3. Has the district lifted the Rift Valley fever measures in writing?
4. Hens: the first guide started with about 100 laying hens for the galley's eggs; the yard has none, yet the galley's plate counts on the farm's eggs. Are hens kept, and where?
5. The 0.32 ha paddock feeds only 2 to 4 does [E]: do the 10 head get cut-and-carry forage or bought hay (D-030)?